

Becoming an ethical researcher

Research Methodology for IT Professionals

Lecture Five, 2 & 3 March 2020

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Crisis of ethics

The world?

South Africa?

Our communities?

In research?



Student Feedback

what's working and what's not!



Student Feedback

Admin

- Venue
- Use of Blackboard (notices, lecture content)

- Blackboard
- Class size
- Time of class
- Being a PT student

Classroom Organisation

- Activities
- Discussions
- Interactivity
- Asking questions
- Working in pairs

Teaching

- Structure & order
- Preparation
- Clarity of communication
- Punctuality
- Teacher-student dialogue

- More notes from lecturer
- Content/theory intensive
- Pace too fast

Learning

- Weekly & preparation tasks
- Being prepared enhances understanding
- Accessible textbook (Kumar)

- Exam anxiety/uncertainty
- Textbook (too many readings, inaccessible, confusing)
- Unsure of learning expectations

CONTENT

- **QUAL vs QUANTS**
- **Types of Research (pure/basic vs applied)**
- **Process of Research**

Learning Pyramid

Ways to improve learning retention

Popular means of representing some relationship between how you learn and levels of retention

CRITIQUE?

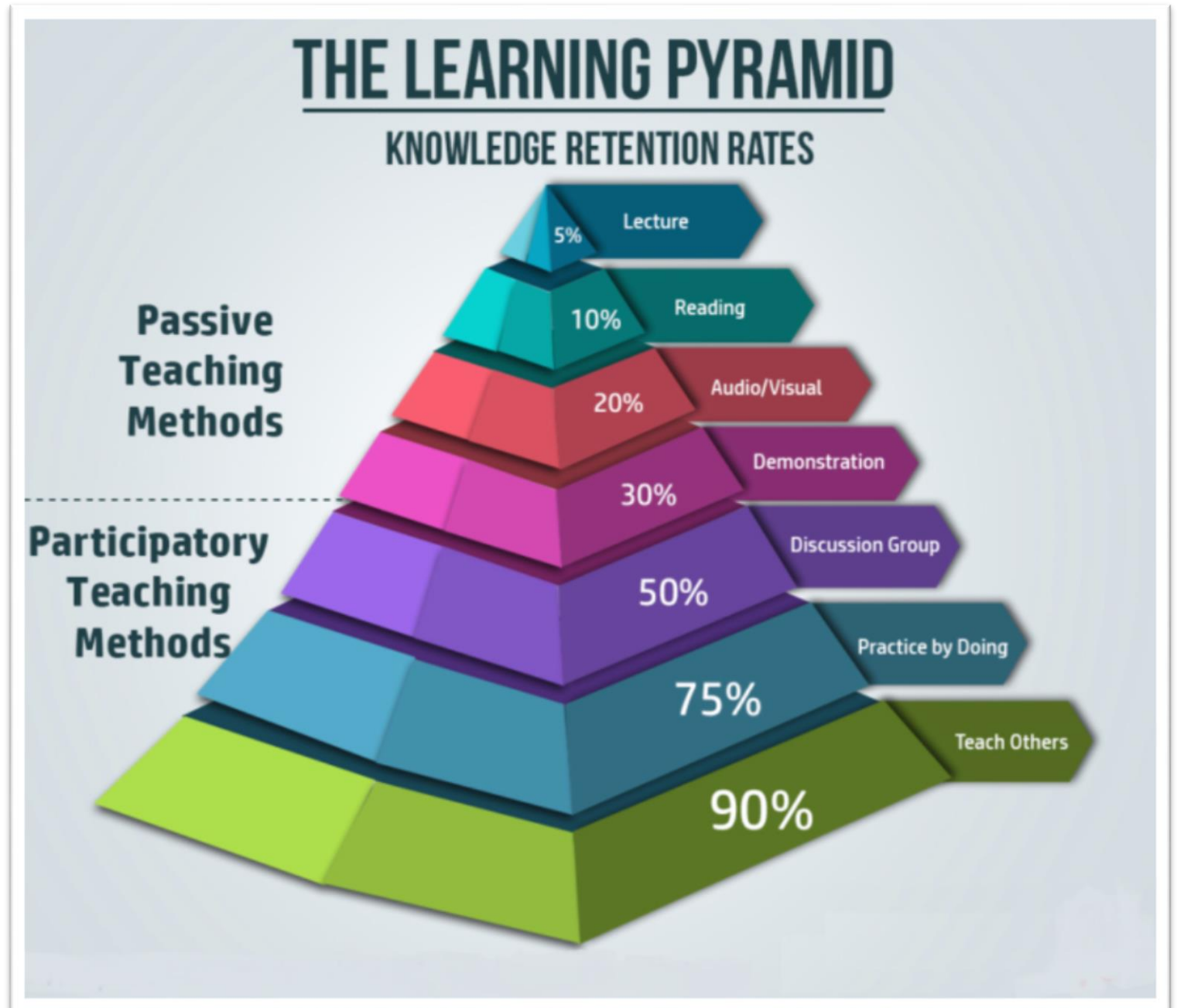
Quantification

Set %'s

Ways to learning presented as independent activities

HELPFUL – in showing what passive and active learning looks like

- Research into active learning more credible, rigorous, valid



Acting ethically as a researcher

Booth et al (2016)
Kumar (2011)

- Shared **code of practice** or **principles of conduct** to ensure that research undertaken doesn't cause harm
 - To participants
 - To community of researchers/discipline you are part of
- Ethical behaviour
 - Acting correctly
 - Adherence to sets of behaviour, values and principles
- Influence on ethical behaviour
 - Time, context/place/situation
- Ethical practice as a research much ensure that
 - You don't cause harm
 - Avoid breach of confidentiality
 - Using information inappropriately
 - Bias
 - Theft of knowledge, acknowledgement and respect

Acting Ethically

1. Stakeholders in research

- Research participants/subjects/respondents
- Researcher
- Funding agency/body

2. Different stages of the research

- Research design
- Data Collection
- Data Analysis
- Writing your research

Group 1	Group 2	Group 3
Plagiarism as a ethical issue Booth et al (2016) - How do the authors understand plagiarism? - What are the features of plagiarism? - Why does plagiarism weaken the community of researchers/discipline?	Ethical practice towards participants Kumar (2011) • What are the main ethical concerns when considering research participants? • What suggestions are made to ensure you act ethically towards research participants	Ethical practice as a researcher Kumar (2011) • What are the main ethical concerns a researcher should be aware of? • What suggestions are made to ensure researcher act ethically during their research investigations

GROUP 1

Plagiarism as a ethical issue

Booth et al (2016)

- How do the authors understand plagiarism?
- What are the features of plagiarism?
- Why does plagiarism weaken the community of researchers/discipline?

GROUP 2

Ethical practice towards participants

Kumar (2011)

- What are the main ethical concerns when considering research participants?
- What suggestions are made to ensure you act ethically towards research participants

GROUP 3

Ethical practice as a researcher Kumar (2011)

- What are the main ethical concerns a researcher should be aware of?
- What suggestions are made to ensure researcher act ethically during their research investigations

Prep for next week

- Ethical research practice
 - Revisit Kumar – Chapter 14
 - Create a list of all the considerations that should be applied to participants, researchers, stakeholders
 - Make detailed notes of what ethical practice applies to each stakeholder
- Catch-up with your readings, slides, notes
 - Bring your questions and uncertainties regarding content for discussion